

Transition Curve

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Emotional arc of disruption

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Transition Curve describes the emotional stages people pass through during disruptive change — from shock and resistance to exploration and commitment — so leaders can support each stage.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Adapted from Elisabeth Kübler-Ross's stages of grief to organisational change by writers such as John Fisher.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed to help leaders anticipate and support the human, emotional reality of change rather than treating it as purely rational.

FIGURE 1 · TRANSITION CURVE

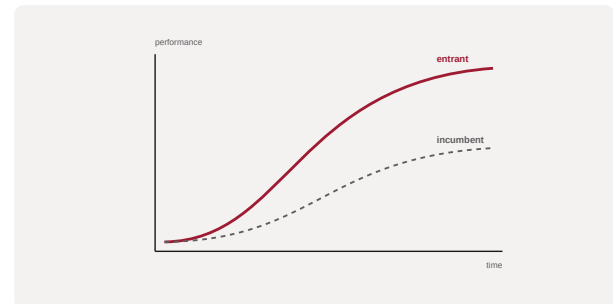


Figure 1. A schematic of the Transition Curve as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

Individuals are met where they are on the curve, with support tailored to their current stage to ease the transition.

WHEN IT IS USED

During disruptive change and transformation.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Change managers, HR and leaders.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It centres the emotional experience of change, complementing process models with human dynamics.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

Kotter's 8 Steps · Slibrary 20

ADKAR Model · Slibrary 20

Burning Platform vs. Burning Ambition · Slibrary 20

Change Readiness Radar · Slibrary 20

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Kübler-Ross, E. (1969) On Death and Dying. New York: Macmillan.

Fisher, J.M. (2005) 'A time for change', Human Resource Development International, 8(2).